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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

MULTI – DISCIPLINARY COURSES (MDC) - MG1MDCAAT100 -
LOGISTICS AND E – COMMERCE OPERATIONS I
(2025ADMISSIONONWARDS)

Duration: 1hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Skill (S), Interest (I) and Appreciation (Ap)

PartA

MCQ
Answer any 10 questions
Each question carries 1 marks

1. b) Military operations [U] / [CO1]
2. c) To move goods from one location to another [K] / [CO1]
3. b) Positioning Equipment [K] / [CO2]
4. b) Reducing costs [K] / [CO2]
5. b) Cost of printing [An] / [CO3]
6. a) Inventory management [U] / [CO3]
7. b) Physical stores [U] / [CO3]
8. b) Business to Business [U] / [CO3]
9. a) Verify authenticity of sender [An] / [CO5]
10. a) Lower operational costs [U] / [CO4]
11. a) Protecting buyer interests [U] / [CO5]
12. a) Mobile device penetration [K] / [CO3]

Part B
Short Answer Questions
Answer any 5 questions
Each question carries 4 marks

13. Examine the advantages and limitations of each mode of transport. [An] / [CO1]

Road transport offers advantages such as flexible routes, door-to-door service, and suitability for short distances, but faces limitations like traffic congestion, limited capacity, and higher per-unit cost. Rail transport provides high capacity, energy efficiency, and cost-effective bulk movement, yet is limited by fixed routes, slower

speed, and high initial infrastructure cost. Air transport ensures fastest delivery, global reach, and suitability for high-value or perishable goods, but its limitations include very high cost, weather dependency, and limited cargo volume. Water transport is economical for heavy and bulky goods and ideal for international trade, but it is slow, affected by weather, and dependent on port infrastructure. Pipeline transport offers continuous, low-cost, and safe movement of liquids and gases, while its limitations include high installation cost, inflexibility, and risk of leakage.

14. Difference between Inbound Logistics and Outbound Logistics [An] / [CO1]

Inbound logistics focuses on the movement of materials into the organization, including activities such as sourcing, purchasing, transportation of raw materials, inventory management, and receiving, while outbound logistics deals with the movement of finished goods from the organization to customers, involving order processing, packaging, warehousing, distribution, and delivery. Inbound logistics aims at ensuring timely availability of inputs for production, whereas outbound logistics aims at ensuring timely delivery and customer satisfaction. Inbound activities emphasize supplier coordination and cost control, while outbound activities emphasize market reach, fast delivery, and service quality.

15. Analyze the concepts of Pull and Push marketing strategies. [An] / [CO4]

Push marketing strategy focuses on promoting products through the distribution channel by "pushing" them towards consumers using methods like trade promotions, discounts, and sales force efforts, while Pull marketing strategy aims to create consumer demand that "pulls" the product through the channel using advertising, branding, and digital engagement. Push strategy emphasizes short-term sales, channel support, and inventory movement, whereas Pull strategy emphasizes long-term brand loyalty, customer attraction, and market awareness. Push works well for new products and low-involvement goods, while Pull is effective for established brands and high-involvement products.

16. Evaluate the effectiveness of different types of procurement in modern business environments. [E] / [CO2]

Different types of procurement vary in effectiveness depending on business needs: Strategic procurement enhances long-term value through supplier collaboration, cost optimization, and innovation; while Operational procurement ensures day-to-day purchasing efficiency but may lack strategic focus. Centralized procurement increases control, standardization, and negotiation power, whereas Decentralized procurement offers flexibility and faster decision-making but may lead to higher costs. E-procurement improves transparency, speed, accuracy, and reduces paperwork, while its effectiveness depends on technological readiness. Global procurement provides access to wider markets and competitive pricing but poses risks related to logistics, cultural differences, and supply chain disruptions. Green procurement supports sustainability goals and improves brand reputation, though it may require higher initial costs and limited supplier availability. Overall, the effectiveness of each type depends on organizational objectives, supply chain complexity, and resource capabilities.

17. Analyze the advantages of the IT Act 2000 and explain how it benefits businesses and individuals. [An] / [CO5]

The IT Act 2000 provides several advantages by giving legal recognition to electronic records and digital signatures, enabling secure online transactions and boosting e-commerce. It enhances cybersecurity through provisions against hacking, data theft, and cyber fraud, thereby protecting both businesses and individuals. The Act supports smooth functioning of e-governance services by allowing digital filing of documents and online communication with authorities. It benefits businesses by reducing paperwork, increasing transaction speed, and promoting digital trust, while individuals gain protection against cybercrimes, misuse of personal data, and online harassment. Overall, the Act strengthens the digital ecosystem, improves operational efficiency, and builds confidence in electronic transactions.

18. Analyze how the key features of E-commerce contribute to improving business efficiency. [An] / [CO3]

E-commerce improves business efficiency through features such as global reach, which allows companies to access wider markets without physical presence, and interactivity, which enhances customer engagement and feedback. Personalization helps businesses offer tailored products and recommendations, increasing conversion rates and customer satisfaction. Online transaction capability ensures faster, secure, and cost-effective payments, while automation of processes like order processing, inventory management, and customer support reduces errors and operational costs. Real-time information flow supports better decision-making, and 24/7 availability increases sales opportunities and convenience for customers. Overall, these features streamline operations, reduce costs, and boost productivity.

19. Analyze the relationship between Cyber Laws and Cyber Crimes. [An] / [CO5]

Cyber laws and cyber crimes are closely related as cyber laws are designed to define, prevent, and penalize cyber crimes such as hacking, identity theft, data breaches, cyberstalking, and online fraud. Cyber laws provide a legal framework that regulates online behavior, sets standards for data protection, and ensures accountability for misuse of digital platforms. As cyber crimes evolve with technological advancements, cyber laws are updated to address new threats, safeguard individuals and businesses, and maintain digital security. Effective cyber laws help deter criminals, support investigation and prosecution, and promote safe use of the internet, while the rise in cyber crimes highlights the need for stronger and more comprehensive legal measures.

PartC
Essay Questions
Answer any 2 questions
Each question carries 10 marks

20. Evaluate the key factors that contribute to the constantly changing dynamic environment in logistics. [E] / [CO1]

The dynamic environment in logistics is constantly changing due to factors such as rapid

technological advancements like automation, AI, and tracking systems, which transform supply chain operations; globalization, which increases cross-border trade and complexity; and fluctuating customer expectations for faster, flexible, and reliable deliveries. Market competition pushes companies to innovate and optimize costs, while government regulations, trade policies, and environmental norms continuously reshape logistics practices. Economic conditions, fuel prices, and global disruptions such as pandemics or geopolitical tensions also influence logistics decisions. Additionally, sustainability demands and the shift toward green logistics require ongoing adaptation. Together, these factors make logistics a continuously evolving and highly responsive sector.

21. Analyze the different types of logistics providers and explain their key functions, highlighting how each type supports supply chain efficiency. [An] / [CO1]

Logistics providers include 1PLs, which involve companies managing their own transportation and storage, offering full control but limited scalability; 2PLs (service carriers) that provide basic transport or warehousing services, helping reduce asset ownership and operational burden; and 3PLs that offer integrated services like transportation, warehousing, inventory management, and order fulfillment, improving efficiency through expertise and technology. 4PLs act as supply chain integrators, managing multiple 3PLs, optimizing processes, providing end-to-end visibility, and enhancing strategic coordination. 5PLs focus on managing entire networks through advanced digital platforms, e-procurement, and automation, driving cost efficiency and global optimization. Each type supports supply chain efficiency by improving service quality, reducing costs, enhancing coordination, and leveraging technology according to the level of service integration.

22. A customer wants to transfer funds and pay bills online. Which E-banking services would you recommend and why? [A] / [CO3]

For a customer who wants to transfer funds and pay bills online, I would recommend using services like Internet Banking, which allows secure fund transfers (NEFT, RTGS, IMPS) and easy bill payments through a single platform; Mobile Banking apps, which offer convenient anytime–anywhere access for quick transfers and utility payments; and UPI services, which provide instant, 24/7 fund transfers and seamless bill payments with minimal steps. Additionally, Bill Pay and Auto-Debit facilities help schedule recurring payments to avoid delays, while Electronic Fund Transfer systems ensure safe and fast movement of money. These services are recommended because they enhance convenience, reduce time, ensure security, and offer real-time transaction updates.

23. What are the main types of e-advertisements? Discuss their advantages. [U]/[CO3]

The main types of e-advertisements include display ads, which use banners and visuals to attract attention and build brand visibility; search engine ads, which appear based on user keywords and offer high relevance and conversion potential; social media ads, which target specific audiences using demographics and interests, improving reach and engagement; video ads, which deliver strong storytelling and higher retention; email marketing ads, which offer personalized promotions to existing or potential customers;

and influencer promotions, which leverage trusted personalities to increase credibility. These e-advertisements are advantageous because they provide targeted reach, cost-effectiveness, real-time performance tracking, global accessibility, personalized messaging, and higher engagement compared to traditional advertising.